StickFrame — Complete Blueprint

Text to Stickman Movie. For Everyone.

1. The Idea

Type anything. Get a stickman movie.

Not for one type of user. For everyone. A kid making a funny video. A teacher explaining photosynthesis. A filmmaker storyboarding a fight scene. A startup pitching their product. A grandkid making a birthday card for grandma. A YouTuber creating daily content. Anybody who wants to tell a story with stickmen.

One engine. One input box. One output: a stickman video. No niche limitations. No "beachhead market" gatekeeping. The tool works for any story, any genre, any user.

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User types:                       Engine renders:

┌───────────────────────┐         ┌────────────────┐
│ scene: rooftop night  │         │    O           │
│ hero blue             │         │   /|\  fight!  │
│ villain red           │  ───▶   │   / \          │
│ villain punches hero  │         │                │
│ hero dodges           │         │   2 min later: │
│ hero kicks villain    │         │   MP4 ready    │
│ villain flies back    │         └────────────────┘
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2. The Product (3-Year Vision)

The Experience

A web platform where anyone types a script and instantly gets a stickman animation video. The interface has a script editor on one side and a preview on the other. Users can customize characters, add props, control the camera, add dialogue, sound effects, and background music. Export to MP4, GIF, or vertical Shorts/Reels format.

Core Features (Year 3):

Feature	Detail
Script-to-Video	Type structured commands, get MP4. Pure deterministic engine. Same script always gives same video.
Multiple Characters	Unlimited stickmen per scene. Each with unique appearance, size, color, accessories.
Action Library	200+ built-in actions: walk, run, jump, wave, sit, stand, fall, kick, punch, hug, dance, point, climb, swim, fly, sleep, cry, laugh, bow, spin, fight, dodge, block, roll, and more.
Props & Weapons	Chairs, tables, swords, guns, cars, balls, boxes, shields, spears, and user-customizable props.
Backgrounds	Classroom, office, park, street, space, underwater, rooftop, forest, desert, castle, and custom background uploads.
Dialogue	Speech bubbles, subtitle tracks, voiceover (via free TTS or user upload).
Sound & Music	Built-in SFX library. Background music tracks. Attach sounds to specific actions.
Camera	Pan, zoom, follow character, shake effects, split screen for simultaneous scenes.

Character Creator	Customize height, proportions, colors, hats, hair, accessories, costumes.
Export	MP4, GIF, PNG sequence, vertical format for Shorts/Reels/TikTok.
API	Programmatic access for developers and integrations.
Marketplace	User-created characters, props, backgrounds, templates for sale.

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3. Video Length & Technical Capability

Length	Use Case	Render Time	Realistic?
15-60 sec	Shorts, Reels, TikTok, memes	5-15 seconds	Instant. Best for viral content.
1-5 min	YouTube, lessons, explainers, sketches	30 sec - 2 min	Sweet spot for daily creators.
5-30 min	Story-driven episodes, tutorials	2-15 min	Doable. Niche but growing.
30 min - 3 hr	Full-length movies	45 min - 2 hr	Technically possible. Niche audience.

The truth: Can we render a 3-hour stickman movie? Yes. Will most users make one? No. The engine is capable of any length, but the demand lives in short-form content (15 sec - 10 min) where creators publish daily. If someone wants to make a 3-hour stickman epic, the engine will not stop them.

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4. Market

Animation is a $534 billion global market. 91% of businesses use video for marketing. 55% of companies have created animated videos. Professional explainer videos cost $5,000-$25,000 each. YouTube stickman channels generate $12,000+ per month with simple content. "Faceless" channels are trending in 2026.

Our product competes with nothing directly because no one else does text-to-stickman. The indirect competition is PowerPoint, Canva, CapCut, Vyond, Animaker, and manual tools like Pivot Animator—all of which require significantly more time or money.

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5. Competitors

Competitor	Stickman?	Text-to-Video?	Price	Threat
Vyond	No (polished cartoon)	No (drag templates)	$649-999/yr	Low
Animaker	No (2D cartoon)	No (drag-drop)	$300-2400/yr	Low
Powtoon	No (slides)	No (templates)	$0-1200/yr	Low
Doodly	No (whiteboard)	No (drag-drop)	$240-828/yr	Low
Pivot Animator	Yes	No (manual frames)	Free	Low
Stick Nodes	Yes	No (mobile manual)	Free	Low
PowerPoint/Canva	No	No	Free-$100/yr	Medium
StickFrame	**Yes**	**Yes**	**$0-$49/mo**	**Unique**

No existing tool offers text-to-stickman automation. The closest alternatives are either manual (Pivot, Stick Nodes) or focused on polished cartoon (Vyond, Animaker) which is a completely different use case.

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6. Defensibility

What Truly Protects Us:

1. **Community Marketplace.** User-created characters, props, backgrounds, and templates for sale. Network effects: more users means more content means more value. Hardest to replicate.
2. **Template Ecosystem.** 100+ pre-built templates for common scenarios. Users stay because their work lives here.
3. **Brand Ownership.** First mover in "text to stickman" category. When someone searches, we are the answer.
4. **Animation Library.** 1,000+ hand-crafted keyframe actions by Year 3. Time-consuming to build, not easily copied.
5. **Proprietary Script Language.** Can be replicated but the ecosystem around it (templates, community, integrations) creates switching costs.

What Is Not a Moat (But I Thought It Was):

- DSL alone — can be copied
- Engine code — open source alternative could emerge
- Rendering pipeline — standard technology

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7. Weaknesses & Mitigations

Weakness	Risk	Mitigation
Stickman has limited visual appeal compared to cartoon	Medium	Embrace it. Stickman is faster, cheaper, and has its own aesthetic appeal. Alan Becker has 17M subscribers with stickman.
Script format requires learning	Medium	Make scripting optional. Provide templates, drag-drop editor, and AI free-form input alongside the script box.
Big player could add stickman feature	Low	Unlikely. Vyond/Animaker would not dilute their brand with stickman. It is a downgrade for them.
Open source clone appears	Medium	Stay ahead on community, templates, marketplace, and integrations. Code is copyable; community is not.
Rendering long videos is slow	Low	Optimize with worker queues and parallel rendering. Most users create short content.
No mobile support at launch	Low	Focus on web first. Mobile in Year 2.

8. 3-Year Roadmap

Year 1:

Quarter	Focus	Key Deliverables	Users (paid)
Q1	MVP	Single stickman, 20 actions, script input, MP4 export, Product Hunt launch. One text box. Generate button. Done.	100
Q2	Characters & Variety	Multiple stickman types, color customization, basic props, GIF export. Template library starts (50 templates).	300
Q3	Quality & Sound	Smooth animation interpolation, 100 actions, scene transitions, backgrounds, sound effects, camera controls.	600
Q4	Polish & Monetize	Subscription plans, watermark removal, referral program, analytics dashboards, performance optimization.	1,000

Year 2:

Quarter	Focus	Key Deliverables	Users (paid)
Q1	Marketplace + Voice	User character store, 50+ props, 20+ backgrounds, free TTS integration, creator revenue share.	1,000
Q2	Advanced Tools	500 actions, fight choreography, multi-scene management, group interactions, split screen.	3,000
Q3	Mobile + Desktop	Mobile web app, offline desktop app (Tauri), export presets for Shorts/Reels/TikTok.	5,000
Q4	Community	User forums, tutorials, template contests, Discord community, template library expansion to 500.	7,500

Year 3:

Quarter	Focus	Key Deliverables	Users (paid)
Q1	API + Platform	Public REST API, developer SDK, webhook integrations, usage-based billing, documentation.	5,000
Q2	Enterprise	Team accounts, collaboration features, version history, SSO/SAML, white-label option.	15,000
Q3	AI Layer (Optional)	Free-form natural language to structured script, AI action suggestion, AI background generation.	20,000
Q4	Ecosystem	Plugin system, integration partners, education licensing, expanded export formats.	30,000

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9. Technology

MVP:

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Frontend: HTML + JS (minimal, single-page)
Backend:  Python
Engine:   Pillow (render stickman frames), ffmpeg (stitch to MP4)
Hosting:  Free tier (Vercel/Netlify)
Domain:   ~$10/year
```

Year 1:

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Frontend: React (script editor with live preview)
Backend:  Python FastAPI
Engine:   Pillow + NumPy, ffmpeg
Database: SQLite → PostgreSQL
Storage:  Local → S3-compatible
Queue:    Redis (async renders)
Auth:     JWT
Hosting:  $10-20/month VPS (Linode/DigitalOcean)
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Video Rendering Performance:

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1 frame:     ~5-10ms (CPU only)
30 fps:      ~150-300ms per second of video
1 min video: ~9-18 seconds render time
10 min:      ~1.5-3 minutes
3 hour:      ~45 min - 2 hours

Optimization: Parallel frame rendering + worker queue.
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10. Why This Works

Factor	Verdict
Problem	Real. Making animation currently requires time (hours per minute), money ($5K+ for professional), or technical skill. This eliminates all three.
Market	$534 billion animation market. Growing. Anyone who needs to tell a story visually is a potential user.
Competition	No direct competitor. Manual tools (Pivot, Stick Nodes) and expensive cartoon tools (Vyond, Animaker) exist but none offer text-to-stickman automation.
Build Cost	Near zero. CPU only. Python, ffmpeg, free hosting for MVP. ~$10 for domain.
Revenue	SaaS subscription. Proven model. Free tier for acquisition, paid tiers for features.
Risk	Low. Bootstrappable. No investors, no GPU servers, no expensive infrastructure.
Timing	Right. Short-form video explosion. Faceless YouTube channels. Anyone can be a creator in 2026.

One-Line Pitch:

"Type anything. Get a stickman movie. No AI weirdness, no GPU needed, no BS."
